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The World War I Thread

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Orzhov
Member

Join Date: Jan 2017
Posts: 74

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07-18-2017, 02:26 AM #16

Revolution in Russia is a perfect setting for Vampire. Carthians aiding the revolutionary forces and Invctus supporting the loyalists and so on. Circle of the Crone trying to hide under the rock

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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10-18-2017, 03:10 PM #17

And now we can add Promethean into the mix too! I'm pumped and not just because it's my expansion. World War 1 is a perfect time period for Promethean Stories.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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Flyboy254
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 703

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10-18-2017, 07:39 PM #18

Well they are the hollow men.

So, we all focus in on Europe, the Middle East, and Africa, but what was happening in South America?

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10-20-2017, 04:38 PM #19

Some random ideas:

- There's some obvious parallels between soldiers coming home with PTSD and Changelings returning form Arcadia to a home where they no longer belong. But they're so strong that you might wonder if you need Arcadia and all things fae at all?

The Kings Raven

Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 3003

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- You could probably ha
after the war with a bu
nothing to help, and mu
- For Hunter: Definitely a time for occult Conspiracies to collapse, or be weakened before WWII finished them off. Groups like America's Freemasons or Victorian occult societies are starting give way to more technological Conspiracies like VALKYRIE. Conspiracies actually fighting in the war feels more WWII than WWI though.
- You could do a weird but potentially very interesting spin on Deviant with draft dodging, the white feather campaign, and basically replacing Deviant's overt active conspiracy with more subtle omnipresent pressure for society. Or maybe this will work better for Demon, with Covers being civilian identities with good reasons not to get shipped off to the front lines and the government replacing the God Machine.
- Hunter again: Who takes over the vigil when just about everyone who knows how to fight is a continent away on the front lines?

"There are no rules. Only Principles and natural laws." - Promethius
My Homebrew no longer fits in a signature, you can find an index of it here.
Full length fan-books I contributed too: Princess: the Hopeful, Leviathan: the Tempest, Dream Catchers

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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06-05-2018, 11:04 PM #20

I just saw this link on Facebook and thought it may be useful if anyone is looking to plan a campaign.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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Caitiff Primogen
Member

Join Date: Mar 2014
Posts: 1351

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06-06-2018, 12:59 AM #21

> *Originally posted by* ***Second Chances***
>
> *In the Great War, the landscape becomes a wasteland that even the Prometheans have difficulty understanding. A new lineage rises from the gases first unleashed in Ypres, and both the living and the Created must wander far from home.*

That's been an Extempore concept of mine for a while now that I've yet to be able to really use.

2

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SunlessNick
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1214

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06-06-2018, 05:12 AM #22

There was a horror film I saw, I can't remember its name. But the plot could essentially be summed as the Front becoming such Hell on Earth that it's created its own devils to preside over it. You could use Inferno or the Shadow Realm for that, or core book horrors.

1

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Corrigan

06-06-2018, 01:29 PM #23

> *Originally posted by* ***SunlessNick***
> *There was a horror film I saw, I can't remember its name. But the plot could essentially be summed as the Front becoming such Hell on Earth that it's created its own devils to preside over it. You could use Inferno or the Shadow Realm for that, or core book horrors.*

Member

Join Date: Feb 2014
Posts: 189

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Deathwatch?

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S

SunlessNick
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1214

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06-07-2018, 01:56 AM #24

> *Originally posted by* ***Corrigan***
> *Deathwatch?*

Sounds familiar.

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Menace
Member

Join Date: Apr 2014
Posts: 527

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06-07-2018, 12:42 PM #25

Where would you place a Mage setting during WW1? Seems like an interesting time, the Free Council hasn't yet reached adulthood and the Arrow hadn't yet abandonned championing of Sleeper causes, so they though against each other on both sides.

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S

SunlessNick
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1214

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06-08-2018, 09:18 PM #26

> *Originally posted by* ***Menace***
> *Where would you place a Mage setting during WW1? Seems like an interesting time, the Free Council hasn't yet reached adulthood and the Arrow hadn't yet abandonned championing of Sleeper causes, so they though against each other on both sides.*

What CInder saif about Italy:

> *Originally posted by* ***Cinder***
> *Also, in Italy you have poets that convince the population to agree going to war with over the top gestures and general patriotic exaltation. A pretty wild moment that will lead to all that idealism to crush against the realities of war. The whole country was not prepared, technologically and culturally, to fight any kind of war against the other big powers of Europe: WW1 put Italy through a crucible that, on one hand, unified the population but, on the other, lead to...certain bad things a few years later.*

... makes me think of Mage. This idealised sense of patriotism and glory vs the grimmer reality sounds like a possible to mirror to the Supernal and the Fallen. Perhaps an early faction of the Free Council supports the war - even in the face of how terrible it is - because they think such a crucible will provoke more Awakenings.

Beast: One of the most common complains, discussions, and hacks about Beast (coming from many different sentiments) is alternate philosophies to that of lessons. WWI is an era where that could be put front and centre.

- At the Front the first and most basic interpretation is what the hell Beasts can possibly have to teach among the trenches?
- Away from the Front, other Beasts may be trying to use the War itself as a lesson: perhaps spreading news about the worst of it, feeding on the reactions, but in the hopes of preventing such a thing happening again; or else they think a big terror some distance away is too much distraction, and people need to be reminded that fear can still find them at home.
- The War consumes every aspect of life in the nations that fight it. Perhaps Beasts who still regard themselves as altered humans are ascendant in this period, regarding the commonality of experience with the people around them as outweighing their supernature. Maybe some use their Lairs to hide people, or for strategic purposes.
- Maybe some Beasts convince themselves that their feedings are ultimately a comfort, even to their victims - a personal, psychic fear providing a refuge away from the cold impersonal fear of industrialised warfare.
- Some would be tempted to say the hell with it. In a world where humans can do that, who cares what Beasts do?
- And what about Heroes? Do any of them doubt the importance of their quests - who cares about monsters when you're facing the world's first tanks? Or do they believe that killing enough Beasts will end the War? Do they regard the War as a tool to be harnessed? Those good Heroes who aren't indiscriminate about hunting Beasts will surely find a lot to do.
- And the Dream itself will be roiliing something fierce. New Chambers, new Horrors, new Insatiables by the truckload.
- And some - some Beasts, Heroes, cultists, or others - will think the War is the Mother feeding for herself...

Overall theme... both Beasts and Heroes, to live themselves, have to work pretty hard at convincing themselves they're right. What happens

when the world kicks all tha

Deviant: Deviants are defined by having their souls cracked open. Shell-shock - or some attempt at treating it - seems like something that could do that. In the latter case, where it's a treatment gone wrong, the conspiracy could be motivated by getting people back to the meat-grinder - but they could also be motivated by entirely positive ends - they might even want to help the Deviants, though the Deviants could still be forgived for having had enough of their help. Of course the Trenches are a place to hide from any number of people looking to hunt you down, and where scars may help disguise Scars. And the game will have a strong dichotomy of conviction vs loyalty - the applicability of that to a wartime setting is obvious.

Hunter: Any of the losing nations could make a good setting for Hunter after the War. The existing order is knocked over, depriving conspiracies of the support networks - both the larger organisations of hunters and those of the monsters they fight will be uniquely vulnerable. That works best for Tier 3 maybe.
The Front itself is good for Tier 1. To quote @Second Chances: "Hunters must march to war while still keeping up the Vigil. Monster hunting is dangerous prospect as it is, but in no-man's land, it's even worse." (It's also a good way to get hunters from different background and groups taken away from their networks and thrown together).
And for Tier 2, to quote @The Kings Raven: "Who takes over the vigil when just about everyone who knows how to fight is a continent away on the front lines?" This is a time when new compacts are needed in every nation.

1

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Boneguard
Member

Join Date: Jun 2014
Posts: 477

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06-09-2018, 09:50 AM #27

I'm sure it's not unique in it's approach but I think you could get some good material from For King and Empire. Although it focus on the Canadian, you have Norm Christie narrating the events, showing the various Great War cemeteries as well as what the battlefields look like today, but it's intersected with actual footage from the War as well as reading of letter that were sent from the front to family mrmbers in Canada.

It could help get the mood of life in the trenches.

Project consolidation:
Rough Draft: Dhole Shifters, Ottawa By Night, Tribebook Bunyip, Garou Variant
In redaction: Lasombra Bloodline

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